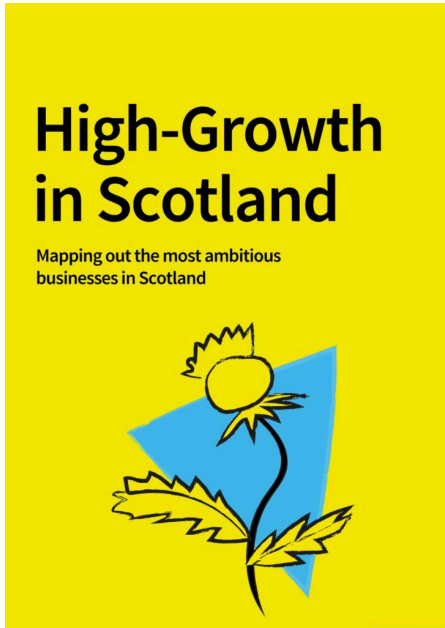




High-Growth in Scotland

Mapping out the most ambitious businesses in Scotland

High-Growth in Scotland

We've taken a closer look at Scotland's high-growth ecosystem and mapped out the most ambitious companies in the country.

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Highland	78	West Lothian	55
Glasgow City	392	West Dunbartonshire	13

Methods of Growth

Attending a competitive accelerator programme is the most popular method of growth for ambitious companies in Scotland. This differs from England and Wales, where equity fundraising is the most common method of growth.

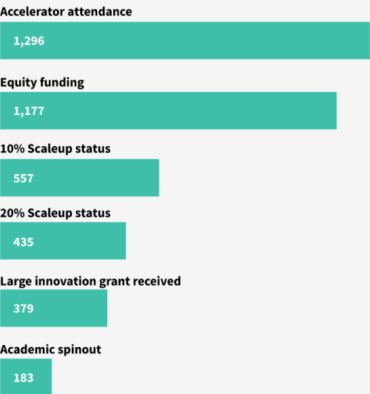
Scotland also has an unusually high proportion of spinout companies. 6% of ambitious businesses have been spun out from an academic institution — double the UK average.

The prevalence of companies growing through accelerators is due in no small part to Natwest's Entrepreneur Accelerator (operating as RBS in Scotland).

Given the sophistication of the country's angel networks and the support of the Scottish Investment Bank, it's not surprising that the proportion of equity-backed businesses matches the south of England.

HENRY WHORWOOD, HEAD OF RESEARCH & CONSULTANCY

Most popular methods of growth in Scotland



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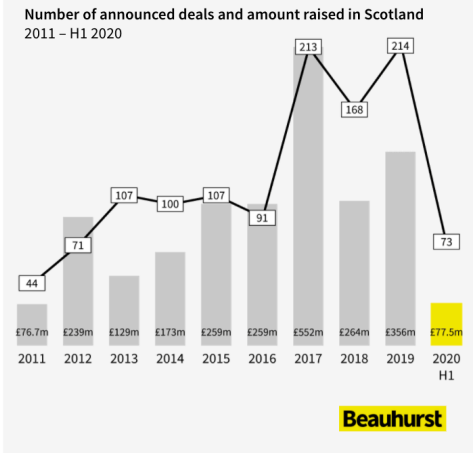
Investments over time

2017 was an especially active year for equity investments in Scotland. 213 deals were completed, with a combined worth of £552m. 2019 was another strong year, with a record 214 deals completed. But this activity looks set to drop in 2020, and by quite a long way at that.

Just 73 investments have been announced in the first half of this year, totalling £77.5m. If investor activity continues on this same trajectory through the second half of the year, then 2020 could see the smallest amount of investment for Scottish businesses since 2013.

Scottish companies seem to be really struggling to access finance in the wake of lockdown. If they were raising in line with the rest of the UK, we would expect nearly £150m to have been raised so far this year.

HENRY WHORWOOD, HEAD OF RESEARCH & CONSULTANCY



This report highlights

High-growth Companies

Funding received

2020

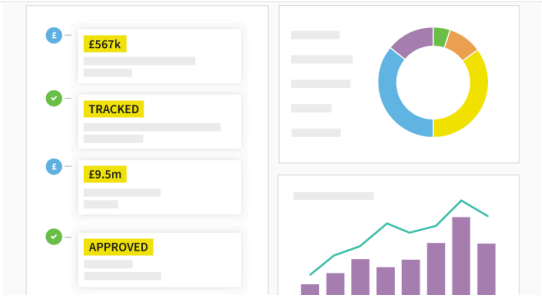
£2.39b

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